Skills Summary

Teen Numerals and Number Words

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — From a number word to a numeral

Rule: A teen word has two pieces: the ones piece, then *-teen* for the one ten.

Write the ten first, then count the ones on: numeral = ten + ones.

Word bank: eleven, twelve, thirteen, fourteen, fifteen, sixteen, seventeen, eighteen, nineteen.

Example: Write the numeral for *sixteen*.

Step 1. The word tells me the two parts of the number, so I split it into its ones piece and its teen piece before writing a single digit.

Step 2. *Six* is the ones and *-teen* is the one ten, so the number is ten and six more.

$10 + 6 =$ **16**

Try it: Write the numeral for *fourteen*.

check: **14**

(!) Watch out: The word says the ones piece first, but the numeral writes the ten first. *Fifteen* is not 51.

Skill 2 — From a numeral to a number word

Rule: Read the ones digit, say its name, then add *-teen* for the ten.

Three words change their sound and must simply be learned: eleven, twelve, and thirteen (not “threeteen”).

Example: Write the number word for the numeral 17.

Step 1. The word is built from the ones digit, so before I can say anything I have to find how many ones the numeral holds.

Step 2. Taking the one ten out leaves $17 - 10$ ones, and the name of that many ones is *seven*. Adding the teen ending gives *seventeen*.

seventeen, with ones part **7**

Try it: Write the number word for the numeral 13.

check: thirteen, ones part **3**

Skill 3 — Finding the ones in a teen numeral

Rule: In every teen numeral the left digit is the one ten and the right digit is the ones.
To check it, take the ten out: $\text{ones} = \text{numeral} - \text{ten}$.

Example: 18 is one ten and how many ones?
Step 1. I want the leftover once one whole ten is set aside, so I subtract that ten rather than counting all the way up from one.
Step 2. Taking the ten out of the numeral leaves $18 - 10$, and the right-hand digit shows the same amount.
8 ones

Try it: 11 is one ten and how many ones?

check: **1** one

Skill 4 — Comparing two teen numerals

Rule: Every teen numeral holds exactly one ten, so the tens always match and cannot decide.
Compare the ones digits: the numeral with more ones is the greater number.

Example: Write $<$, $>$, or $=$ between 17 and 12.
Step 1. Both are teen numerals, so their tens are equal and comparing them tells me nothing; only the ones digits can settle it.
Step 2. The ones digit of the first numeral is larger than the ones digit of the second, so the first number is greater and the wide end faces it.
$\mathbf{17 > 12}$

Try it: Write $<$, $>$, or $=$ between 13 and 18.

check: $\mathbf{13 < 18}$